

Week 9 Lit Example Worksheet

JULIUS CAESAR: WHEN THE REASON ASSUMES THE VERDICT

Purpose: Apply Week 9's method to Brutus's reasoning. Find where the conclusion is assumed and rewrite for independent support.

Directions: Use the Lit Example Reader. Do not collapse circularity with mere emotional force.

Part 1: Brutus Alone

Part 1 Q1: What conclusion does Brutus announce at the opening of Passage 1?

Part 1 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 1 Q2: What present evidence about Caesar does Brutus admit is weak or missing, and what future danger does he rely on instead?

Part 1 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 2: Circularity Test

Part 2 Q1: Could a fair opponent accept Brutus's main reasons without already accepting that Caesar must die? Explain.

Part 2 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 2 Q2: Where does “Fashion it thus” or the serpent’s-egg comparison risk assuming the verdict?

Part 2 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 3: Public Speech

Part 3 Q1: In Passage 2, how can the ambition → death move become circular or question-begging if ambition is not independently proved?

Part 3 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 3 Q2: How does the slaves/free-men alternative pressure the crowd in a way that may assume the danger still needing proof?

Part 3 Q2 ANSWER BOX

Part 4: Rewrite

Part 4 Q1: Rewrite Brutus's case in non-circular form: keep a clear claim and state what independent evidence would be required before death is justified.

Part 4 Q1 ANSWER BOX

Part 4 Q2: In one paragraph, explain how Week 9's tool helps a reader separate a coherent speech from a proved conclusion in these passages.

Part 4 Q2 ANSWER BOX